3. Weighted Grades & Act 95

From the January Act 95 hearing to the November Board meeting: the working document, timeline, emails and the caregiver survey.

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Act 95 Timeline

Source: Wisconsin Legislative Council act memo for 2023 Wisconsin Act 95 (docs.legis.wisconsin.gov), plus district dates from this record.

Date	What happened
Feb 22, 2024	2023 Wisconsin Act 95 takes effect.
2024–25 school year	High schools with at least 15 students in a class must rank students at the end of 11th grade, **based only on GPA**, identify the top 5% and 10%, notify students in the top 10%, and put the rank on the transcript.
2025–26 admissions	Guaranteed UW admission begins: top 10% of a Wisconsin high school class to any UW campus except UW-Madison; top 5% to UW-Madison.
Dec 2025 – Jan 2026	Students survey 903 SPASD students about class rank and weighted GPA.
Jan 26, 2026	Student Act 95 group presents findings at the Board's public hearing.
Feb – Oct 2026	Weighted grades work group, with students, builds the plan.
Oct 16–22, 2026	District caregiver survey: 531 responses, 70% support.
Nov 2 and Nov 9, 2026	Plan previewed with Board members, then taken to the Committee of the Whole.
Late Nov 2026	Final Board vote expected.

Why it matters: because rank must be based only on GPA, how the GPA is calculated (weighted or not) decides who lands in the top 5% and 10%.